The Engineering Island

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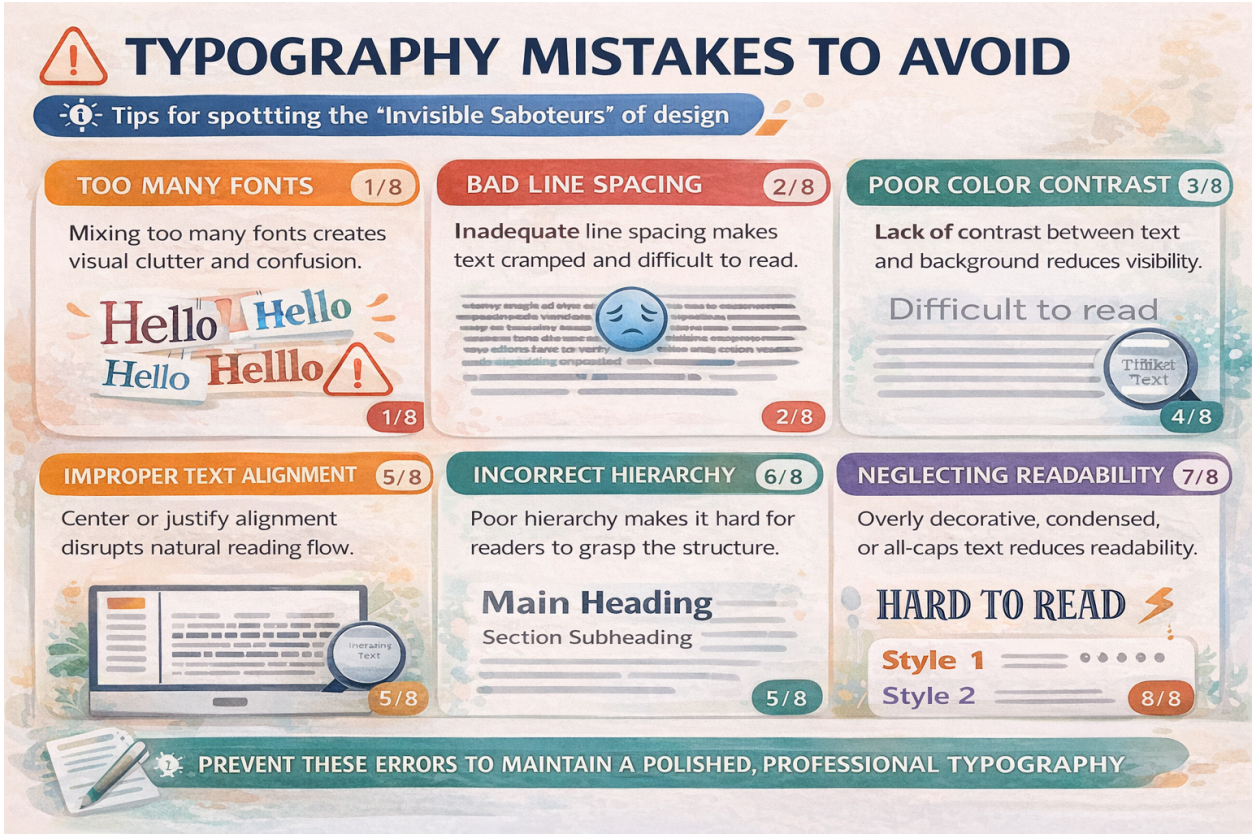
Lesson 7: Typography Mistakes to Avoid

As this typography series concludes, the focus shifts from applying best practices to recognizing and preventing common typographic mistakes. Even experienced designers can unintentionally introduce small errors that significantly impact readability, professionalism, and user experience. These errors are often subtle, yet they can undermine an otherwise well-designed layout.

Typography functions as a communication system, and like any system, its effectiveness depends on careful execution. Poor typographic decisions may not always be consciously noticed by readers, but they often create a sense that something feels “off.” This phenomenon occurs because the human brain is extremely sensitive to patterns, rhythm, and visual balance. When typography disrupts these patterns, readers experience visual friction, which slows comprehension and reduces engagement.

For this reason, professional designers must learn to identify and avoid what can be described as the “invisible saboteurs” of typography—mistakes that quietly weaken the clarity and credibility of a design. The following sections examine several of the most common typographic pitfalls and explain how designers can correct them to maintain a polished and effective visual presentation.



1. The Chaos of Uneven Rags

In typography, the rag refers to the irregular edge of text in paragraphs that are aligned flush-left or flush-right. When text is aligned to the left margin, the right edge of the paragraph becomes uneven, forming what is called a ragged margin.

A well-formed rag should appear natural and balanced, with subtle variation between line lengths. However, when line lengths vary dramatically, the paragraph develops a bad rag, characterized by awkward shapes in the margin. These shapes may form deep vertical gaps often called "rivers," "canyons," "wedges," or "bellies."

Such irregular patterns can distract readers by drawing their attention toward the empty spaces rather than the text itself. Instead of focusing on the meaning of the words, the reader's eye becomes preoccupied with the uneven white space along the edge of the paragraph.

Bad rags typically occur when line breaks are left entirely to automatic text formatting. While modern layout software provides efficient text-wrapping algorithms, these systems cannot always produce visually pleasing results.

Professional designers often refine rags manually using several techniques:

- Adjusting line breaks to create more balanced line lengths

- Applying subtle hyphenation to reduce extreme gaps
- Slightly modifying tracking or word spacing to smooth the margin
- Editing the text itself when possible to improve line flow

The goal is not to create perfect symmetry but rather to achieve a soft, organic edge that does not visually compete with the content. When executed properly, the rag should appear natural and unobtrusive, allowing the reader's eye to move smoothly through the paragraph.

2. Improper Font Selection and Character Mismatch

Another common mistake in typography is the selection of typefaces that are inappropriate for the intended message or context. Every typeface carries a specific visual personality shaped by its historical origins, stylistic features, and cultural associations. When the tone of the typeface conflicts with the tone of the content, the result is a disconnect between form and meaning.

For example, a playful handwritten font may work well for a children's birthday invitation or a craft store advertisement. However, using the same font for a serious medical report or legal document would appear unprofessional and diminish the credibility of the information being presented.

This problem is often referred to as typographic mismatch, where the emotional tone of the typeface contradicts the purpose of the content. In branding and communication design, such mismatches can lead to confusion or mistrust among viewers.

Design agencies emphasize the importance of typographic appropriateness, which means selecting fonts that visually reinforce the message being communicated. A financial institution, for example, might use a stable and authoritative serif font to convey reliability and trust. A technology company might choose a modern sans-serif typeface that communicates efficiency and innovation.

When typography aligns with the meaning of the text, the design achieves a state of visual harmony, where form and content support each other. This alignment strengthens the emotional impact of the message and improves the overall effectiveness of the design.

3. The Visual Friction of Mixing Too Many Typefaces

Font pairing is an essential skill in typography, but excessive mixing of typefaces can quickly disrupt visual harmony. When too many fonts appear within a single design, the result often looks disorganized and amateurish.

Each typeface has its own unique structure, rhythm, and proportions. When several unrelated fonts appear together, the visual system loses its sense of consistency. Readers must repeatedly adjust to new letter shapes, which increases cognitive effort and interrupts the reading experience.

Professional designers typically limit the number of typefaces used in a project. A widely accepted guideline is the “Rule of Two,” which recommends using one typeface for headings and another for body text. Occasionally, a third typeface may be introduced for accents or special elements, but exceeding this number often leads to visual clutter.

Maintaining a limited typographic palette allows designers to create a coherent visual language. Once readers become familiar with the chosen typefaces, they can focus on the structure and meaning of the content rather than constantly adjusting to new visual styles.

Instead of adding more fonts to create variation, designers often rely on internal variations within a type family, such as different weights, styles, or sizes. This approach provides enough contrast to establish hierarchy while preserving overall consistency.

When typography remains consistent throughout a project, the design feels more professional and trustworthy.

4. Excessive Line Width and Reader Fatigue

One of the most overlooked typographic mistakes occurs when paragraphs stretch across the entire width of a large screen or page. While wide layouts may appear spacious, they often create lines of text that are too long for comfortable reading.

Reading involves a series of rapid eye movements known as saccades, where the eyes jump from word to word across a line of text. At the end of each line, the eyes must quickly locate the beginning of the next line. When lines become excessively long, this return movement becomes difficult, causing readers to lose their place or skip lines accidentally.

This difficulty results in reader fatigue, where prolonged reading becomes physically uncomfortable. As a result, users may abandon the content before finishing it.

Research in typography and usability has identified an optimal line length of approximately 50 to 75 characters per line for body text. Some digital design guidelines extend this range slightly to around 80 characters, but exceeding this range significantly reduces readability.

Designers can control line length by adjusting:

- The width of text containers
- The number of columns in a layout

- Font size and spacing

By restricting text width, designers create a clear reading path that allows the eyes to move smoothly from one line to the next. This simple adjustment dramatically improves reading comfort, particularly for long-form content such as articles, blogs, or research papers.

5. The “Font Overload” Trap

A common misconception among beginner designers is that using many different fonts will make a design appear more creative or visually interesting. In reality, excessive font usage often produces the opposite effect.

When multiple fonts compete for attention, the design loses its sense of unity. The viewer’s eye becomes overwhelmed by conflicting styles, making it difficult to determine which information is most important.

This mistake is sometimes described as font overload, where the abundance of typographic styles dilutes the clarity of the layout.

Professional designers approach typography with a philosophy of intentional simplicity. Rather than introducing additional fonts, they create variation through internal adjustments within existing typefaces.

These adjustments may include:

- Changing **font weight** (light, regular, bold)
- Applying **italic styles** for emphasis
- Adjusting **font size** to establish hierarchy
- Using **capitalization or small caps** for specific elements

By manipulating these internal variables, designers can build a sophisticated hierarchy while maintaining a unified typographic system.

This disciplined approach strengthens both readability and brand identity. When typography remains consistent across a design, users quickly learn how to navigate the information, resulting in a smoother and more intuitive reading experience.

Conclusion: Avoiding Mistakes to Achieve Professional Typography

Mastering typography requires more than understanding its principles—it also requires the ability to identify and eliminate subtle design errors that compromise clarity and usability.

Mistakes such as uneven rags, inappropriate font selection, excessive typeface mixing, overly long line lengths, and font overload may seem minor, but their cumulative effect can significantly weaken a design. By recognizing these pitfalls and applying thoughtful corrections, designers can transform ordinary layouts into polished and effective visual communication.

Professional typography ultimately depends on precision, consistency, and awareness of how readers interact with text. When designers avoid these common mistakes, typography becomes invisible in the best possible way—allowing the message to shine while the design quietly supports the reading experience.

Webflow. (2022). Importance of typography. https://webflow.com/blog/importance-of-typography

Fitz-Patrick, M. (2026, January 24). The UX Designer's Guide to Typography. https://ixdf.org/literature/article/the-ux-designer-s-guide-to-typography

Obys Agency. (n.d.). Typography principles. https://typographyprinciples.obys.agency/

The Layout Fixer: Expert Audit (Questions 1-15)

The Mission: You are the **Chief Design Officer**. The project is 90% finished, but it's "unpolished." Your job is to spot the subtle errors that an amateur would miss.

1. The "Belly" Distraction (Rag)

Scenario: A high-end interview layout has a paragraph where the right edge (the Rag) has a massive "bulge" in the middle.

- **Question:** What is the technical name for this "bad rag" shape that disrupts reading flow?
- **Choices:** A. A Canyon | **B. A Belly** | C. A Wedge | D. A River.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Look at the right margin. If the lines in the middle are much longer than the top and bottom, it creates a "curve" that pulls the eye away from the text.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! A **Belly** creates an uneven visual weight that distracts the reader.

2. The "Credibility" Gap (Appropriateness)

Scenario: A bank is sending a digital "Security Breach" alert to its users, but the font used is **Bubble-Gum Rounded**.

- **Question:** Why is this a failure of "Typographic Appropriateness"?
- **Choices:** A. The x-height is too high | **B. The font's personality contradicts the gravity of the message** | C. It's a Sans-Serif | D. The tracking is too wide.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** If you are being told your money is at risk, do you want the

message to look like a birthday party invitation or a serious document?

- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! The typeface must act as a **Visual Synonym** for the content.

3. The "Tennis Match" Fatigue (Measure)

Scenario: On a wide desktop screen, a blog post spans 1200px. Readers say they keep losing their place.

- **Question:** What is the primary cause of this "Reader Fatigue"?
- **Choices:** A. Bad Color Contrast | **B. The Measure is too long (over 100 characters)** | C. The Leading is too loose | D. The Font-Size is 16px.
  [Image showing the difference between poor and optimal line length (measure) for readability]
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** If a line of text is too wide, the eye has to travel a long distance. When it tries to jump back to the start of the next line, it gets lost.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Spot on! Restricting the **Measure** to 75–80 characters is a fundamental rule of UX.

4. The "Internal Variables" Strategy

Scenario: You need to distinguish between a "Category" label and a "Title," but you only have one font family.

- **Question:** Instead of adding a 2nd font, how should you create this distinction professionally?
- **Choices:** A. Change the background color | **B. Manipulate the Weight and Case (e.g., Bold + All-Caps)** | C. Use a different font for every label | D. Underline everything.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Look at the "Internal Hierarchy." Can you make a label look different just by changing it to All-Caps and making it Bolder?
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! Using **Internal Hierarchy** maintains a unified "Central Nervous System" for the design.

5. The "Optical Doubling" Trap

Scenario: A paragraph has 140% leading, but because the lines are 120 characters long, people still skip lines.

- **Question:** Why does a long measure require even *more* leading (line spacing)?
- **Choices:** A. To make the page look longer | **B. To help the eye navigate the long "return trip" to the next line** | C. To increase the x-height | D. To fix a bad rag.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** The further the eye has to travel to the right, the harder it is to find the correct line when it "zips" back to the left. Extra vertical space acts as a guide.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Exactly. Long lines require **Generous Leading** to prevent

"Optical Doubling."

6. The "Font Soup" Diagnostic

Scenario: A website uses a different font for the Logo, Header, Nav-bar, Body, and Buttons.

- **Question:** What is the main risk of this "Font Overload"?
- **Choices:** A. It makes the site load too fast | **B. It makes the design look like a collection of unrelated parts** | C. It increases the contrast ratio | D. It fixes the x-height.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Consistency is professional. If every element has a different "DNA," the user's brain has to work harder to understand the system.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! The **Rule of Two** ensures the brand identity remains concentrated and authoritative.

7. The "Negative Space" Saboteur

Scenario: In a column of text, you see a vertical "white snake" or "river" running through the paragraph.

- **Question:** This error, common in Justified text, is called a "River." How do you fix it?
- **Choices:** A. Increase the font size | **B. Adjust the Tracking or switch to Flush-Left alignment** | C. Change the typeface | D. Bold the text.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** A "River" happens when word spaces accidentally line up vertically. To break the river, you need to change how the words are spaced horizontally.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! **Rivers** distract the eye; switching to **Flush-Left** is the safest way to kill them.

8. The "Subconscious Trust" Audit

Scenario: You are designing a "Terms of Service" page. The text is set in a **High-Contrast Fashion Serif** (thin hairlines).

- **Question:** Why is this a technical mistake for a "Data-Heavy" legal page?
- **Choices:** A. It looks too expensive | **B. Thin hairlines can break and become unreadable at small sizes** | C. It has too many ascenders | D. Serifs are illegal in law.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Think about the "Medium." If the lines of the letters are too thin, what happens to them on a low-resolution screen or a small smartphone?
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct. For legal or data text, you need **Sturdy, Low-Contrast** fonts for high legibility.

9. The "Cognitive Dissonance" Test

Scenario: A fitness app uses a very thin, light-weight font for its "Power Lifting" workout headlines.

- **Question:** Which term describes this mismatch between "Weight" and "Meaning"?

- **Choices:** A. Visual Harmony | **B. Cognitive Dissonance** | C. Type Scale | D. Kerning.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** If the word is "HEAVY" but the font looks like a thin "whisper," your brain feels a disconnect.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! This disconnect causes the user to subconsciously doubt the brand's message.

10. The "Touch-Target" Margin

Scenario: A mobile design has two links placed directly next to each other with no "Air" (Negative Space) between them.

- **Question:** Why is this a UX "Saboteur"?
- **Choices:** A. It looks crowded | **B. It causes "Fat-Finger" errors where users tap the wrong link** | C. It ruins the word shape | D. It increases the Leading.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Think about the physical interaction. A mouse is precise; a thumb is not. What do links need to be "safe" to tap?
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Spot on. **Accessibility** requires space for physical interaction.

11. The "Hierarchical Map" Failure

Scenario: A page has 5 different sections, but every heading is the same size, weight, and color.

- **Question:** What fundamental typographic principle is missing?
- **Choices:** A. Color Contrast | **B. Information Hierarchy** | C. Monospacing | D. Anatomy.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Without a "Visual Map," the reader doesn't know where one section ends and the next begins. You need to make the headings stand out.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! **Hierarchy** tells the reader's brain how to navigate the information.

12. The "Aggressive" All-Caps Error

Scenario: A paragraph of "Instructions" is set entirely in **All-Caps Bold**. Users say it feels like the app is "shouting" at them.

- **Question:** Beyond the "shouting" feel, why is All-Caps bad for long paragraphs?
- **Choices:** A. It uses more battery | **B. It removes the unique "Word Shapes" (Bouma), making reading slower** | C. It makes the text look too modern | D. It decreases the tracking.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Humans recognize words by their "skyline" (tops and bottoms). If everything is a rectangle (All-Caps), those shapes disappear.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct. **Lowercase** characters are essential for fast reading.

13. The "Baseline Shift" Micro-Fix

Scenario: You are using a font where the "Copyright" symbol (©) looks too high compared to the text.

- **Question:** What "Micro-Typography" tool do you use to nudge that single character down?
- **Choices:** A. Kerning | **B. Baseline Shift** | C. Leading | D. Tracking.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** You aren't moving the line, just one specific character vertically.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! **Baseline Shift** is the professional's tool for fine-tuning character alignment.

14. The "Halation" Dark-Mode Fix

Scenario: In Dark Mode, white text on black looks "blurry" because the white light is bleeding into the black space.

- **Question:** How should you adjust the **Tracking** to fix this?
- **Choices:** A. Decrease Tracking (Tighten) | **B. Increase Tracking (Loosen)** | C. Make it Bold | D. Change to Italic.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** If the "light" is bleeding together, do the letters need to be closer together or further apart to stay clear?
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! **Loose Tracking** in Dark Mode prevents the "glow" from overlapping the letters.

15. The "Golden Ratio" Size Check

Scenario: You have a body text size of 16px. You want your Headline to look "mathematically perfect" in comparison.

- **Question:** Which tool helps you choose a headline size based on a consistent multiplier (like 1.618)?
- **Choices:** A. A Grid System | **B. A Type Scale** | C. A Kerning Table | D. A Contrast Checker.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Professional designers don't just "guess" sizes. They use a **Scale** to make sure the jump between sizes feels intentional.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! A **Type Scale** creates harmony and professional polish.

🕹️ The "Precision Pairing" Masterclass (Expert Level)

The Mission: You must pair a **Heading** with a **Body** font. You aren't looking for "contrast"; you are looking for **Systemic Harmony**.

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1. The "Humanist Harmony" (Optical Flow)

Mission: A high-end healthcare brand needs a "Warm but Professional" look. You've chosen a **Humanist Serif** for the body.

- **Header Options:**
  - **A.** A Geometric Sans (Perfect circles).
  - **B.** A Neo-Grotesque (Neutral, like Helvetica).
  - **C. A Humanist Sans with matching "Calligraphic" stroke modulation.**
  - **D.** A Slab Serif with square terminals.
  - **E.** A Monospaced "Code" font.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Look at the "axis" of the letters. If the Serif body has a slight tilt (like a pen), a perfectly vertical, robotic Sans-Serif header will feel "Disconnected."
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! Pairing **Humanist with Humanist** ensures the "Handwritten DNA" carries through the whole layout.

2. The "X-Height" Stability Test

Mission: You are pairing two different font families for a dense news app. If the "Torsos" of the letters don't line up, the baseline will feel like it's "vibrating."

- **Header Options:**
  - **A.** A font with tiny x-height and tall ascenders.
  - **B. A font with a Large X-Height that matches the Body font's "Torso" height.**
  - **C.** A font with a heavy "Stroke Contrast."
  - **D.** An Ultra-Condensed font.
  - **E.** A Script font.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Look at the height of the lowercase 'x'. If the header's 'x' is much shorter than the body's 'x', the lines of text won't feel like they belong on the same planet.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Spot on. Matching **X-Heights** is the secret to making two different fonts feel like a "unified system."

3. The "Aperture" Synchronization

Mission: You are designing a **Wayfinding App** (GPS). The body font has "Open Apertures" for legibility. The header must match this functional logic.

- **Header Options:**
  - **A.** A font where the 'c' and 'e' are nearly closed circles.
  - **B. A font where the 'c' and 'e' have wide, open gaps.**
  - **C.** A font with very thin hairlines.
  - **D.** A font with "Reverse Contrast."
  - **E.** A Blackletter font.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Consistency in "Aperture" (the holes in the letters) is vital. If the body is easy to read at a glance, but the header "clogs up" and looks like an 'o', the system fails.

- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct. **Open Apertures** across both fonts ensure high-speed legibility for the entire interface.

4. The "Contrast Ratio" Balance

Mission: You are using a **High-Contrast Serif** (very thin and thick lines) for a fashion logo. You need a Sans-Serif subhead that doesn't "overpower" the elegance.

- **Subhead Options:**
  - **A.** A heavy, blocky Sans-Serif.
  - **B. A "Monolinear" Sans-Serif (the strokes are the same thickness as the Serif's hairlines).**
  - **C.** A Rounded Sans-Serif.
  - **D.** A Slab Serif.
  - **E.** A Brush Script.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** If the subhead is too "chunky," it will steal the spotlight from the elegant Serif. Look for a font that matches the "thinness" of the Serif's most delicate lines.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Expert move. Matching the **Stroke Weight** of the Sans-Serif to the **Hairline** of the Serif creates a sophisticated, "airy" balance.

5. The "Terminal" Geometry Match

Mission: You are using a **Geometric Sans** (like Futura) for your headings. You need a Serif for the body that shares the same "Geometric Soul."

- **Body Options:**
  - **A.** A Humanist Serif (Organic).
  - **B.** A Transitional Serif (Traditional).
  - **C. A "Didone" Serif (constructed with vertical lines and perfect circles).**
  - **D.** An Old-Style Serif (Renaissance).
  - **E.** A Handwritten Script.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** A Geometric Sans is built with a ruler and compass. Which Serif style looks like it was "Engineered" rather than "Written"?
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! **Didone Serifs** share the mathematical rigidity of Geometric Sans-Serifs, making them a "Power Couple."

6. The "Bowl" Shape Consistency

Mission: Your primary font has "O"s that are perfectly round. You need a secondary font for the "Call to Action" buttons.

- **Button Options:**
  - **A.** A font with "Oval" or "Square" bowls.
  - **B. A font with matching "Circular" bowls.**
  - **C.** A font with "Compressed" vertical letters.

    - **D.** A Script font.
    - **E.** A Monospaced font.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Look at the "O" and the "p". If one font is "Round" and the other is "Oval," they will clash like a circle trying to fit into a square hole.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct. Matching the **Geometric "Bowl" Shape** is a subtle detail that creates an "Invisible Harmony."

7. The "Historical Context" Pairing

Mission: You are designing a brand for a **Modernized 18th-Century Winery**. You've chosen a classic **Old-Style Serif** for the labels.

- **Secondary Font Options:**
    - **A.** A 1990s "Grunge" font.
    - **B.** A High-Tech "Cyber" Sans.
    - **C. A "Humanist Sans" (derived from the same 18th-century pen movements).**
    - **D.** A Geometric Sans (1920s Bauhaus style).
    - **E.** A Slab Serif (1800s Industrial Revolution).
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** Fonts are like time travelers. If you pair a Renaissance-era Serif with a 1920s industrial Sans, the "Time Gap" will feel jarring. Find its historical cousin.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! **Humanist Sans** and **Old-Style Serifs** both share the "DNA of the Pen," creating a timeless pairing.

8. The "Ascender" Proportion Check

Mission: You are using a font with very tall **Ascenders** (the "sticks" on the 'h', 'l', and 'd'). You need a secondary font that doesn't look "stunted" next to it.

- **Secondary Font Options:**
    - **A.** A font with very short, "stumpy" ascenders.
    - **B. A font with matching Tall Ascenders.**
    - **C.** A font with no lowercase letters.
    - **D.** A font with thick "Slab" serifs.
    - **E.** A font with "Reverse Contrast."
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** If the "limbs" of your two fonts don't reach the same height, the paragraph will look like it's "limping."
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct. Matching **Ascender Proportions** ensures a consistent "Vertical Rhythm."

9. The "Stroke Modulation" Sync

Mission: You are using a Sans-Serif with **"Low Modulation"** (the strokes are the same thickness all the way around).

- **Body Font Options:**

    - **A.** A high-contrast Serif (thick and thin).
    - **B. A "Slab Serif" (also monolinear, with equal thickness).**
    - **C.** A script with varying pressure.
    - **D.** A font with "Shadow" effects.
    - **E.** An Italic-only font.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** If one font is "flat" (no thickness change) and the other is "dynamic" (lots of thickness change), the pairing will feel "noisy." Keep the "Weight Logic" the same.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Correct! **Low Modulation Sans** pairs perfectly with **Slab Serifs** for a sturdy, industrial look.

10. The "Optical Weight" Illusion

Mission: You are pairing a "Light" Serif with a "Bold" Sans-Serif for a mobile app. The Sans-Serif looks "too heavy" and is crushing the Serif visually.

- **Correction Options:**
    - **A.** Make the Serif even thinner.
    - **B. Increase the Tracking and Leading of the Serif to give it more "Visual Presence."**
    - **C.** Change the Sans-Serif to a Script.
    - **D.** Make both fonts the exact same pixel size.
    - **E.** Underline the Serif.
- **IF WRONG: HINT:** You don't always need to change the font. Sometimes, adding "Air" (Negative Space) around a delicate font makes it appear "Stronger" next to a heavy neighbor.
- **IF RIGHT: SUCCESS:** Exactly. **Negative Space** is a tool for balancing the "Optical Weight" of contrasting font pairs.